Coimisiún na Scrúduithe Stáit
State Examinations Commission

LEAVING CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION, 2022

English - Higher Level - Paper 2

Total Marks: 140

Duration: 3 hours 20 minutes

Candidates must attempt the required number of questions in **any TWO** of the following sections:

- SECTION I – The Single Text
- SECTION II – The Comparative Study
- SECTION III – Poetry, Part A, Unseen Poem and Part B, Prescribed Poetry.
- All sections carry 70 marks.

N.B. Candidates are **NOT** required to answer on Shakespearean Drama.

INDEX OF SINGLE TEXTS

All the Light We Cannot See	Page - 2
A Doll's House	Page - 2
Othello	Page - 2
Frankenstein	Page - 3
The Picture of Dorian Gray	Page - 3

Do not hand this up.

This document will not be returned to the State Examinations Commission

SECTION I THE SINGLE TEXT (70 marks)

Candidates must answer **one** question from this section (**A – E**).

A **ALL THE LIGHT WE CANNOT SEE** – Anthony Doerr

(i) "By incorporating elements of history, mystery and legend into the story, Anthony Doerr adds to the narrative power of his novel, *All the Light We Cannot See.*"

Discuss the reasons why you do or do not agree with the above statement, developing your discussion with reference to the text.

OR

(ii) Discuss the insights you gain into the character of Werner Pfennig from his engagement with both Marie-Laure LeBlanc and his sister, Jutta. Develop your discussion with reference to Anthony Doerr's novel, *All the Light We Cannot See*.

B **A DOLL'S HOUSE** – Henrik Ibsen

(i) Discuss how Ibsen skilfully creates moments of heightened dramatic intensity in his play, *A Doll's House*. Develop your discussion with reference to at least three moments of heightened dramatic intensity evident in the text.

OR

(ii) Discuss the insights we gain into Nora Helmer's character from her engagement with both Christine Linde and Nils Krogstad. Develop your discussion with reference to Ibsen's play, *A Doll's House*.

C **OTHELLO** – William Shakespeare

(i) Discuss how Shakespeare skilfully creates moments of heightened dramatic intensity in his play, *Othello*. Develop your discussion with reference to at least three moments of heightened dramatic intensity evident in the text.

OR

(ii) Discuss the insights we gain into the character of Iago from the relationships he carefully cultivates with both Roderigo and Cassio. Develop your discussion with reference to Shakespeare's play, *Othello*.

D **FRANKENSTEIN** – Mary Shelley

(i) "By incorporating elements of science fiction, gothic fiction and horror into the story, Mary Shelley adds to the narrative power of her novel, *Frankenstein*."

Discuss the reasons why you do or do not agree with the above statement, developing your discussion with reference to the text.

OR

(ii) Discuss the insights you gain into the character of Victor Frankenstein from his relationships with both the monster and Henry Clerval. Develop your discussion with reference to Mary Shelley's novel, *Frankenstein*.

E **THE PICTURE OF DORIAN GRAY** – Oscar Wilde

(i) "By incorporating elements of philosophy, melodrama and satiric comedy into the story, Oscar Wilde adds to the narrative power of his novel, *The Picture of Dorian Gray*."

Discuss the reasons why you do or do not agree with the above statement, developing your discussion with reference to the text.

OR

(ii) Discuss the insights you gain into the character of Dorian Gray from his relationships with both Basil Hallward and Sibyl Vane. Develop your discussion with reference to Oscar Wilde's novel, *The Picture of Dorian Gray*.

SECTION II THE COMPARATIVE STUDY (70 marks)

Candidates must answer **one** question from **either A** – Literary Genre **or B** –Cultural Context **or C** – General Vision and Viewpoint.

Candidates who answer a question in **SECTION I** – The Single Text, may not refer to the same text in answer to a question in this section.

All texts used in this section must be prescribed for comparative study for this year's examination. Candidates may refer to only one film in the course of their answers.

Please note:

- Questions in this section use the word **text** to refer to all the different kinds of texts available for study on this course.
- When used, the word **reader** includes viewers of films and theatre audiences.
- When used, the term **technique** is understood to include techniques employed by all writers and directors of films.
- When used, the word **author** is understood to include all writers and directors of films.
- When used, the word **character** is understood to refer to both real people and fictional characters in texts.
- When used, the words **narrative** or **story** are understood to refer to both real life and fictional texts.

A LITERARY GENRE

1. (a) Discuss how effectively two features of storytelling, evident in **one** text on your comparative course, are used to develop one central relationship in this text. Develop your response with reference to the text. (30)

(b) Compare how effectively at least one feature of storytelling, evident in each of **two** other texts from your comparative course, is used to develop one central relationship in each of these texts. You may refer to the same or different feature(s) of storytelling in each of your chosen texts. Develop your response with reference to your chosen texts. (40)

OR

2. Compare how the authors create a sense of anticipation for readers in advance of significant developments or dramatic events in each of **at least two** texts on your comparative course. Develop your response with reference to your chosen texts. (70)

B CULTURAL CONTEXT

1. (a) Discuss the extent to which individual rights are respected or threatened in the cultural context established in **one** text on your comparative course. Develop your response with reference to the text. (30)

(b) Compare the extent to which individual rights are respected or threatened in the cultural context established in each of **two other** texts on your comparative course. Develop your response with reference to your chosen texts. (40)

OR

2. Compare how democratic you find the society established in **at least two** texts on your comparative course. Develop your response with reference to your chosen texts. (70)

C GENERAL VISION AND VIEWPOINT

1. (a) Discuss the extent to which your sense of the general vision and viewpoint in **one** text on your comparative course was influenced by your response to the prevailing values evident in this text. Develop your response with reference to the text. (30)

(b) Compare the extent to which your sense of the general vision and viewpoint in **two other** texts on your comparative course was influenced by your response to the prevailing values evident in these texts. Develop your response with reference to your chosen texts. (40)

OR

2. Compare the extent to which your sense of the general vision and viewpoint in **at least two** texts on your comparative course was shaped by how successfully a significant conflict or tension was resolved in each of these texts. Develop your response with reference to your chosen texts. (70)

SECTION III POETRY (70 marks)

Candidates must answer **A** – Unseen Poem **and B** – Prescribed Poetry.

A UNSEEN POEM (20 marks)

Read the following poem by Simon Armitage and answer **either** Question **1 or** Question **2** which follow.

The English Astronaut

He splashed down in rough seas off Spurn Point.
I watched through a coin-op telescope jammed
with a lollipop stick as a trawler fished him out
of the waves and ferried him back to Mission
Control on a trading estate near the Humber Bridge.
He spoke with a mild voice: yes, it was good to be
home; he'd missed his wife, the kids, couldn't wait
for a shave and a hot bath. 'Are there any more
questions?' No, there were not.

I followed him in his Honda Accord to a Little
Chef on the A1, took the table opposite, watched
him order the all-day breakfast and a pot of tea.
'You need to go outside to do that,' said the
waitress when he lit a cigarette. He read the paper,
started the crossword, poked at the black pudding
with his fork. Then he stared through the window
for long unbroken minutes at a time, but only at the
busy road, never the sky. And his face was not
the moon. And his hands were not the hands of a man
who had held between finger and thumb the blue
planet, and lifted it up to his watchmaker's eye.

Simon Armitage

1. (a) Discuss the portrayal of the English astronaut by Simon Armitage in the above poem. Support your answer with reference to the poem. (10)

(b) Explain how the meaning of the above poem is enhanced by the observations made by the poet in the last two sentences. (10)

OR

2. Discuss how effectively, in your opinion, the poet uses language in the above poem to convey his thoughts and feelings about the astronaut. Support your answer with reference to the poem. (20)

B PRESCRIBED POETRY (50 marks)

Candidates must answer **one** of the following questions (**1 – 5**).

1. **W.B. Yeats**

Discuss how Yeats uses language, including imagery, to convey both passion and frustration in his work. Develop your discussion with reference to the poetry by Yeats on your Leaving Certificate English course.

2. **Emily Dickinson**

"Dickinson pushes the boundaries of both language and imagination to explore a variety of experiences and emotions in her poetry."

Discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the above statement. Develop your discussion with reference to the poetry by Emily Dickinson on your Leaving Certificate English course.

3. **Brendan Kennelly**

"Kennelly uses a conversational style to communicate the emotional, imaginative and spiritual aspects of his poetry to readers."

Discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the above statement. Develop your discussion with reference to the poetry by Brendan Kennelly on your Leaving Certificate English course.

4. **D.H. Lawrence**

"Lawrence uses a vivid and evocative style to present a variety of memorable scenes and moments of emotional intensity in his poetry."

Discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the above statement. Develop your discussion with reference to the poetry by D.H. Lawrence on your Leaving Certificate English course.

5. **Elizabeth Bishop**

"Bishop's precise use of language enables her to effectively convey her reflections on her own life and experiences."

Discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the above statement. Develop your discussion with reference to the poetry by Elizabeth Bishop on your Leaving Certificate English course.

Copyright notice
This examination paper may contain texts or images for which the State Examinations Commission is not the copyright owner, and which may have been adapted, for the purpose of assessment, without the authors' prior consent. This examination paper has been prepared in accordance with Section 53(5) of the Copyright and Related Rights Act, (2000). Any subsequent use for a purpose other than the intended purpose is not authorised. The Commission does not accept liability for any infringement of third-party rights arising from unauthorised distribution or use of this examination paper.

Do not hand this up.

This document will not be returned to the State Examinations Commission

Leaving Certificate – Higher Level

English

3 hours and 20 minutes